

Media Intake

The Simple Guide

Drop a video onto one file. Get back audio you can share, audio built for transcription, and a clean video that plays anywhere. **No commands to type. Nothing to learn.**

Drag & drop

That is the whole interface

5 minutes

One-time setup

Never edits

Your originals stay untouched

.mp3

To listen

Normal audio. Share it, put it on your phone, play it anywhere.

.flac

To transcribe

Tuned for Whisper, Colab and Gemini. Upload this one for text.

.mp4

To watch

Clean video that plays on any device and uploads without fuss.

WHAT IS INSIDE

PART 1	One-time setup	Install the engine, choose where files are saved
PART 2	Using it	Drag, drop, wait. Four steps and you are done
PART 3	What you get	The three files, and which one to reach for
PART 4	When something goes wrong	Every message it can show you, and the fix
PART 5	Optional extras	Safe to ignore. Here for the day you need it

You only ever do this once. After it, the tool is just drag and drop, forever.

1 Install FFmpeg

Media Intake is the remote control. FFmpeg is the engine that does the actual work. Without it, nothing happens.

The easy way, on Windows 10 or 11:

1. Click Start, type `Terminal`, right-click it, choose **Run as administrator**.
2. Copy the line below, paste it in, and press Enter.

PASTE THIS

```
winget install Gyan.FFmpeg
```

3. Wait for it to finish, then **close that window completely and open a new one**.
4. Check that it worked:

THEN THIS

```
ffmpeg -version
```

If you see a few lines of text beginning with `ffmpeg version`, you are done. If you see *not recognized*, use the manual way below instead.

1b The manual way, only if the above did not work

1. Go to `gyan.dev/ffmpeg/builds` and download **ffmpeg-release-essentials.zip**.
2. Right-click the downloaded file and choose **Extract All**.
3. Open the extracted folder, then open the `bin` folder inside it.
4. You will see `ffmpeg.exe` and `ffprobe.exe`. You need **both**.
5. Copy both files into the same folder where you keep `Media_Intake.bat`.

That is all. Media Intake looks for them right next to itself, so there is nothing else to configure.

2 Choose where your finished files go

By default everything is saved to `F:\Lecture`. If you have an F: drive and that suits you, skip this step entirely.

1. Right-click `Media_Intake.bat` and choose **Edit**, or **Open with** → **Notepad**.
2. Near the top, find this line:

FIND

```
set "OUT_ROOT=F:\Lecture"
```

3. Change the path to anything you like:

CHANGE TO

```
set "OUT_ROOT=D:\My Lectures"
```

4. Save the file and close Notepad.

YOU CANNOT BREAK THIS

If the folder you pick does not exist or cannot be written to, the tool notices, says so on screen, and saves your files next to itself in a folder called `Media_Intake_Output` instead. Nothing is ever lost.

PART 2 Using it

every time

1

Find your video or audio file

Anywhere on your computer. MP4, MKV, MOV, TS, MP3, M4A and the rest all work.

2

Drag it on top of Media_Intake.bat and let go

You can drop **several files at once**. Select them all, drag the whole group over, and the tool works through them one at a time.

3

A black window opens and starts working

Leave it alone. Moving numbers mean it is running, not stuck.

4

When it says Finished, press any key to close

Your files are waiting in the output folder.

How long does it take?

The MP3 and the transcription audio are quick, usually a minute or two for each hour of recording. The clean MP4 takes considerably longer, because the video itself is being rebuilt. For a full-length lecture, expect it to run for a while and let it get on with it.

Is my original file safe?

Yes. Media Intake only ever *reads* your original. It never moves it, changes it, or deletes it. Everything new is written to a separate folder.

IN A HURRY?

The video step is the slow one. If you only need the audio today, see Part 5 for the `/audioonly` switch, which finishes in a fraction of the time.

Say you dropped a file called **Lecture 4.mp4**. You will find a folder named after today's date, so no two runs can ever overwrite each other.

```
D:\My Lectures\2026-08-23\Lecture 4\  
|  
+-- Lecture 4.mp3           audio for listening and sharing  
+-- Lecture 4__16k_mono.flac audio for transcription  
+-- Lecture 4.mp4           clean, universally playable video  
+-- ffmpeg_run.log          a record, only needed if something failed
```

Which one do I use?

You want to listen to it	the MP3
You want a written transcript	the FLAC
You want to watch or upload the video	the MP4

THE FLAC SOUNDS ODD, AND THAT IS CORRECT

Play it and it will sound flat, quiet and slightly lifeless. That is deliberate. It has been converted to mono, reduced to 16 kHz and volume-levelled, because that is exactly what transcription software wants. It is not broken. For listening, use the MP3.

Extra folders you might see

FOLDER	WHY IT APPEARED
mp3_parts	Your MP3 came out larger than 199 MB. Many sites and chat apps refuse uploads that big, so the same audio was also saved in smaller pieces. The full MP3 is still there. Use whichever suits.
mp4_parts	You asked for the video to be cut into chunks using the <code>/chunk</code> switch in Part 5. Otherwise this folder never appears.

The tool tells you what happened in plain words. Here is every message it can show you, and what to do about each one.

WHAT YOU SEE	WHAT TO DO
[ERROR] ffmpeg was not found	Part 1 Step 1 did not finish. Open a <i>new</i> terminal and try <code>ffmpeg -version</code> again, or switch to the manual method.
[ERROR] ffprobe was not found	You copied only <code>ffmpeg.exe</code> . Go back and copy <code>ffprobe.exe</code> as well. Both are required.
[WARN] Cannot write to F:\Lecture	That drive is not there. Nothing was lost. Your files went into <code>Media_Intake_Output</code> next to the tool. Set your own folder using Part 1 Step 2.
[SKIP] File not found	The file was moved or renamed after you dragged it. Try again.
[SKIP] That is a folder	You dropped a folder rather than a file. Open it and drop the files inside.
[INFO] No video stream	Perfectly normal for audio files such as MP3 or M4A. The video step is simply skipped.
[FAIL] ... See the messages above	Scroll up in the black window. FFmpeg prints the reason there. A damaged or half-downloaded source file is the usual cause.
The window flashes and vanishes	FFmpeg is missing, or Windows has blocked the file. Right-click <code>Media_Intake.bat</code> , choose Properties , tick Unblock if you see it, then OK.

The summary line

Every run ends with a single line that tells you how it went:

```
Finished. files: 3 ok: 3 failed: 0 skipped: 0
```

If **failed** and **skipped** are both zero, everything worked.

PART 5 Optional extras

safe to ignore

YOU MAY SKIP ALL OF PART 5

The defaults are right for almost everyone. This part exists only for the day you want something slightly different out of a single run.

Open the folder that contains `Media_Intake.bat`, click the address bar at the top of the window, type `cmd` and press Enter. A black window opens in that folder. Now you can add a switch to the end of the tool's name, like

this:

EXAMPLE: AUDIO ONLY, NO VIDEO, MUCH FASTER

```
Media_Intake.bat /audioonly "lecture.mp4"
```

ADD THIS	AND IT WILL
/audioonly	Skip the video and make audio only. Far quicker.
/nomp3	Skip the MP3.
/notext	Skip the transcription file.
/wav	Make a WAV instead of a FLAC for transcription.
/copy	Also save an untouched copy of the original audio.
/chunk 15	Also cut the finished video into 15-minute pieces.
/out "D:\Somewhere"	Save this one run somewhere else.
/?	Show the complete list on screen.

To see them all at any time, in that same window run:

```
Media_Intake.bat /?
```

Quick reference

Everything above, on one card.

SETUP	Install FFmpeg, then pick your output folder. Once, and never again.
USE	Drag the file onto Media_Intake.bat. Wait. Done.
LISTEN	The .mp3
TRANSCRIBE	The .flac, the one that sounds flat on purpose
WATCH	The .mp4
ORIGINALS	Never touched. Read only, always.
IN A HURRY	/audioonly skips the slow video step
BROKE?	Read the black window. It says what went wrong, and Part 4 says what to do.